

DALLAS COWBOYS INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — a new defensive coordinator, a rebuilt front, and a franchise-tagged receiver reporting to Oxnard without a holdout.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

Schottenheimer	Christian Parker	\$27.3M	Missed	Oxnard
HC · YEAR 2	NEW DC	PICKENS FRANCHISE TAG	2025 PLAYOFFS	CAMP SITE

FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **Eberflus fired.** Dallas dismissed defensive coordinator **Matt Eberflus** after one of the worst defensive seasons in franchise history and hired Eagles defensive backs coach **Christian Parker** to replace him.
- ◆ **Defensive staff turnover.** Parker brought in his own assistants; the offensive staff stayed largely intact, adding only Kyle Fuller (asst. OL/QC) and Stephen Bravo-Brown (asst. WRs).
- ◆ **Front office unchanged.** Calls for outside leadership — including fan speculation about Troy Aikman — go nowhere. Dallas remains a family business, and any succession runs through **Stephen Jones**.
- ◆ **Year 2 under Schottenheimer.** The first season had highs, but missing the playoffs again made it a clear disappointment.

TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **TRADE** **Rashan Gary from Green Bay** (March 9) for a 2027 fourth-rounder — the headline answer to a pass rush that had much to prove.
- ◆ **TRADE** **Osa Odighizuwa to San Francisco** for a 2026 third-round pick (No. 92).
- ◆ **SIGNED** S **Jalen Thompson** — three years, up to \$33M, the biggest free-agent commitment of the offseason.
- ◆ **SIGNED** QB **Sam Howell** from Philadelphia, plus one-year deals for a former Charger (up to \$3M) and a former Ram (\$5.5M).
- ◆ **PARSONS HAUL** The 2025 Micah Parsons trade closed out through this draft: first-round picks in 2026 and 2027 plus DL **Kenny Clark** became, among others, edge **Malachi Lawrence** (23rd), CB **Devin Moore** (114th) and DL **LT Overton** (137th). Stephen Jones says the club feels "really good" about it.
- ◆ **LOST** WR **Jalen Tolbert** to Miami; S **Thomas** to Indianapolis.

PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **George Pickens, WR.** Playing on the **franchise tag at \$27.3M** after career highs of 93 catches, 1,429 yards and nine touchdowns. He plans to participate fully — **no holdout** — and joined Dak Prescott's Park City workout with CeeDee Lamb and the skill group. Dallas wants a second season of evidence before committing long term.
- ◆ **Dak Prescott, QB.** The offense was the functional half of 2025 and returns essentially intact, with Lamb and Pickens both in camp.
- ◆ **The new defense.** ESPN's framing of this camp is blunt: how fast can Parker's scheme get up to speed? Dallas is installing a new system with a substantially new front.
- ◆ **Rashan Gary, EDGE.** The pass rush's centerpiece addition, acquired to replace production Dallas has been chasing since the Parsons trade.
- ◆ **Kenny Clark & the interior.** Clark plus rookie LT Overton reset a defensive line that also shipped out Odighizuwa.
- ◆ **Malachi Lawrence, EDGE (23rd overall).** The most direct on-field return from the Parsons deal, arriving into an immediate role.

LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Rashan Gary, EDGE	Trade with Green Bay for a 2027 fourth
▲ Jalen Thompson, S	3 yr, up to \$33M
▲ Sam Howell, QB	Signed from Philadelphia
▲ Lawrence, Moore, Overton	2026 draft class from the Parsons haul
▲ Christian Parker	Hired as defensive coordinator
▼ Matt Eberflus, DC	Fired after historically poor defense
▼ Osa Odighizuwa, DT	Traded to San Francisco for pick No. 92
▼ Jalen Tolbert, WR	Signed with Miami

THE BOTTOM LINE

Dallas spent 2025 proving that a very good offense cannot outrun a historically bad defense. The response was surgical rather than sweeping: fire the coordinator, import Gary, spend the Parsons capital on the front seven, and let the offense alone. The best news of the summer is the least dramatic — **George Pickens is showing up, tagged and unhappy-free**, throwing with Prescott in Utah. If Christian Parker's install takes, this roster is a playoff team. If it doesn't, the questions move up a floor.